



Southern Africa

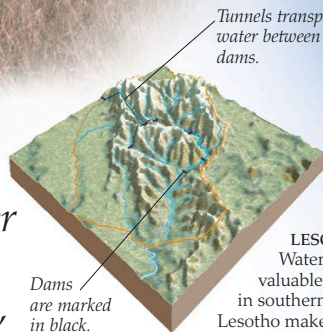
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FROM THE DRAMATIC Namib and Kalahari deserts in the west, to the tropical forests in the north, southern Africa is a region of contrasts. Oil, diamonds, gold, and other precious metals are all mined here. There are huge inland plains that are home to a variety of wildlife, and large areas devoted to agriculture. But flooding and droughts, together with civil unrest, have hampered development so that, despite an abundance of natural resources, many countries remain poor.

SAN BUSHMEN

One of the few groups of hunter-gatherers left in Africa, the San people roam the Kalahari Desert. Also known as Bush people, many San are now changing to a more settled life, often working on cattle ranches.

San hunter using a poison-tipped arrow



Tunnels transport water between dams.

Dams are marked in black.

LESOTHO
Water is a valuable resource in southern Africa, and Lesotho makes good use of its mountainous land and numerous rivers. The Highlands Water Scheme uses dams and tunnels to transport water to neighboring South Africa.

The Okavango River does not run out to sea like most rivers, but runs inland into the Kalahari Desert.

JOHANNESBURG, SOUTH AFRICA

More than 9 million people live in Johannesburg and its surrounding urban area. Many people have moved here from the countryside in search of work.

GOLD MINING

Gold, first discovered near Johannesburg in 1886, brought a great deal of wealth to the region. South Africa is among the world's top gold-producing countries.

